

OE3C Planning Meeting 6

Date: 08 Jan 2026

Location: Online

Time: 11:04 AM – 12:02 PM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Reem Mahamoud, Sarah Hein, Nicholas Benton, Matthew Summerville, Madelaine Legault, Cassia Hamilton, Wylan Clitheroe, Lauren Nesbitt, Harry Kumbhani, Kiyoko Gotanda

Chair: Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

Meeting started at 11:04 AM (waiting for a group to leave the CRN meeting room).

Budget and fundraising update with Alex and Kiyoko

- Currently working on the application for AGS funding, which is due on Jan 15
- Mentioned that a formal thank you needs to be sent to the FMS Dean's office for their funding support
- Kiyoko confirmed that we received the Exchange Grant for OE3C (~\$6500)
 - o Kiyoko will do the travel and room bookings for plenary speakers, \$5000 will be allocated for plenary speaker expenses
- Alex asked everyone to please start claiming sponsors from the fundraising sheet as soon as possible, to begin contacting people

Quick notes about Trello with Alex

- During the Winter term, please post agenda items by Tuesday on the week of our meetings
- Please check off tasks on the Trello board when completed

Workshops and outings update with Nick and Madelaine

- They figured out when the workshops are taking place (dates and time slots in the rough schedule)
- Their goal is to have an official list of what workshops will be taking place, and they already have an idea of what to do for a few workshops
 - o Hikes

- Wylan is waiting for the rough schedule to plan when the hikes will take place
 - Focussed on connecting people to the local area and nature
 - Helping people feel more immersed in nature
 - Will be working on the hike script to have completed by our next meeting
 - Nick suggested having a subcommittee meeting to discuss workshops and hikes
 - Anyone is free to join the meeting to discuss ideas, such as figuring out funding or passes
 - Re-wilding theme about ecosystem integrity
 - Can be done at the Glenridge Quarry Naturalisation Site
 - Biodiversity theme which will involve hosting hikes at different times of the day
 - Madelaine asked if a location had been picked for this hike yet
 - Wylan has an idea to go to Short Hills or somewhere along the Bruce Trail
 - The evening hike would have a different theme and needs to be local for safety reasons (e.g. people will need headlamps to see where they're going)
 - Nick mentioned that they will also work on planning backup workshops in case the weather affects hiking plans
 - Madelaine asked if salamanders could be a potential theme/idea for the evening hike
 - Nick explained that there are vernal pools near Niagara College where salamander populations have been found (the salamanders go to those pools to mate)

- Visiting the vernal pools could be a potential outing idea
- There will also be an Ethology-themed hike
- Please reach out to Wylan with any ideas on Teams
- Wine tasting
 - Lauren suggested involving Bre (?) for this, Alex confirmed that organisation plans will involve Steve and Taylor instead

Keynote update with Harry

- Received the survey results (10 results total) and decided on the plenary speakers for OE3C
 - Ecology – Jesse Popp
 - Top result was actually Robin Kimmer, but we will not be going with this option due to the following:
 - She is constantly booked
 - Only does 1 trip a month
 - Usually needs to be booked 12 to 24 months in advance
 - Kiyoko recommended skipping this option because we will also have to pay a fee on top of that
 - Ethology – Maydianne Andrade (Lyly is excited)
 - Evolution – Nancy Chen
- Harry will have the letters done by the end of the week for peer-review
 - Kiyoko requested to be cc'd on the emails being sent to plenary speakers (and the OE3C gmail)
- Proposed Ideas being tabled for the next planning meeting
 - Seminars
 - Possibility to host webinars leading up to the conference
 - Round table discussion
 - Could involve local faculty/profs and industry partners

Website update with Lauren (on Rasa's behalf)

- Lauren confirmed that Rasa is trying to make the OE3C website more southern Ontario themed
 - Rasa has worked through the feedback given from the OE3C team
 - Sarah will proofread the website for any typos

- Alex suggested putting a list of changes on a Word doc and sending the file to Rasa
- Matthew confirmed they have uploaded photos of Miriam and Katherine on Teams to be included on the website
- Madelaine noticed on the website that the theme is still “Co-existing with Nature” and asked if we confirmed the new theme would be “Co-existing within Nature”
 - Madelaine checked the 17 Nov 2025 minutes and confirmed that the theme is titled “Coexisting Within Nature”
 - Those changes will be made to the OE3C website and logo

Registration update with Reem

- Reem is waiting to hear back from Lucas (from Conference Services) and discussing registration prices
 - Alex will speak to Brock catering to see if the registration fees will be enough to cover food costs
 - Kiyoko suggested sending a follow up email to Lucas each week
 - They also asked Reem to let us know what is going on with the registration page as changes are made
- Kiyoko asked for an approximate timeline on any changes or releasing the website link for registration
 - Reem needs to wait for Lucas’ response but confirmed that they have the information ready to start the website and it would be ideal to start asap
 - Nick asked if we would be including the call for abstracts on the registration site
 - Reem confirmed this would need to be done separately (e.g. through Google Forms)
 - The options to register/pay for the banquet, workshops, merchandise, and parking passes are add-ons that need to be added afterwards

Rough schedule update with Alex

- Alex uploaded the schedule on Teams (under “Files and documents” > “Schedule”)
- Day 1 will include an early registration for people wanting to go on morning hikes and open registration throughout the day
- Kiyoko brought up that there are no coffee breaks and they are unsure about the idea to hold lunch/brunch in the morning on day 3

- Alex confirmed that the coffee breaks are built into the talks/poster sessions
 - Alex also mentioned that we don't know if we will need the full time slot for talks and posters
 - Nick explained that past conferences they attended had coffee and poster set up in the morning
 - People could view the posters during the day (poster preview) then come back to the poster session
 - Kiyoko asked why there is a poster preview on Friday but not Saturday
 - Alex confirmed we will work on fixing that because it would be good to have this section for both days
- Kiyoko asked why one of the keynote sessions are being scheduled in the Thistle building and not in Pond Inlet
 - Alex explained they thought the location would be easier for people to move around
 - Kiyoko suggested keeping the keynotes in Pond, so we don't switch rooms around too much
 - Alex agreed with this idea
- Alex explained that the presentation session times will be adjusted when we know how many talks are registered and asked the team to please leave feedback regarding the schedule
 - Feedback can be submitted as comments on the spreadsheet or we can make a copy of the spreadsheet in a new tab of the workbook and move things around

Ads and communications update with Matthew and Lauren

- Matthew's update
 - Sent out a New Years post to introduce the OE3C 2026 team and showed the logo in a separate post before Christmas
 - Wants to do posts about fun nature facts about the Niagara Region
 - Wylan and Cassia are willing to help with this
 - Anyone interested in helping should contact Matthew
 - Kiyoko suggested uploading a spreadsheet on Teams to coordinate with people
 - Also suggested to start following people on BlueSky
 - Alex suggested to follow Dan Mennill and repost/retweet/reskeet his posts

and also suggested for everyone on the team to follow the OE3C socials

- Lauren's update
 - Thinking of contacting Elena for a list of university contact emails to send an OE3C update with a flyer
 - Harry has an email list, but it is a bit incomplete
 - We will start with this list and update the emails
 - Alex suggested to contact Elena with the email Lauren wants to send with a brief explanation of what the email is for
 - Alex has a Canva premium account that can be shared with Lauren to create and download any flyers they need
 - Kiyoko suggested that Matthew can start pinning things on social media as well once the flyer is out
 - We need to contact separate admins from different faculties at Brock
 - If we have a draft, we can use that template to send to multiple contacts
 - Shirts and merchandise for OE3C
 - Lauren suggested placing the logo on tote bags and notebooks if we are onboard with this idea
 - Suggested going through Vista Print but it can be expensive
 - Alex and Katherine know contacts from Vista print if we need help
 - We don't know if we want the kinds of tote bags that Vista Print offers
 - Lauren can get the tote bags done through her dad's work
 - Lanyards could also be an option
 - Lauren asked what kinds of shirts we would want
 - V-neck shirts are more expensive than the regular t-shirt
 - Alex recommends OE3C people get V-necks to look more professional and confirmed that OE3C volunteers should have shirts too
 - Sarah asked what colours the shirts would be
 - Alex suggested that the team/volunteer shirts can be navy and everyone else can be red
 - Alex asked what brand of shirt we would be getting and for a copy of the catalog
 - Lauren will check with her dad

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- Kiyoko suggested that people will want to buy the conference t-shirts if we sell them
- Alex will put further items for discussion in a form so we can vote on our ideas
 - Lauren can work with Reem to add t-shirt orders to registration page

General discussion/questions

- Cassia asked if we agreed on holding a banquet
 - Alex will check the last form and contact people that are interested in being on the banquet committee
- Alex reminded everyone that room CRN 527 will be open on Thursdays, 11am-12pm for OE3C team members to work on tasks, meet, etc.

Meeting adjourned at 12:02 pm.